

Setting Up \$PROFILE

```
if ((-not (Test-Path -Path $PROFILE)) -and
($PSVersionTable.PSVersion.Major -GE 7)) {
    New-Item -Path $PROFILE -ItemType File -Force
} elseif ( $PSVersionTable.PSVersion.Major -LT 7 ) {
    Write-Host "Make sure to use PowerShell 7 when creating your profile."
    -ForegroundColor Yellow
}
```

Make sure to run this in PowerShell, NOT WINDOWS POWERSHELL.

SecretStore and SecretManagement

SecretStore and SecretManagement modules work together to provide a locally saved (meaning that it's saved on your computer, *not the network*) encrypted vault of secrets.

```
Install-Module Microsoft.PowerShell.SecretManagement
Install-Module Microsoft.PowerShell.SecretStore
```

Create a Vault and Add a Secret

First you must register the vault. The `Name` parameter is a friendly name and can be any valid string.

```
Register-SecretVault -Name Credentials -ModuleName
Microsoft.PowerShell.SecretStore -DefaultVault
```

If this is the first vault you've created, which should be the case for most of you, you will be prompted to create a password. Make this something memorable as if you forget this password you lose access to your vault forever and have to start over with a new one.

The `DefaultVault` parameter makes this the default vault. Now you can create a secret.

```
Set-Secret -Name cred-a -Secret (Get-Credential)
```

Once again, the `Name` parameter is a friendly name and can be any valid string. I'm using `cred-a` in my vault for my -a credentials, but you can make it anything you want.

There are a couple of things to take note of here with how we're storing the secret. The first is that we're not simply saving our password as a string by typing it in directly; instead, we call `Get-Credential` which will prompt us for a username and password and save them as a credential object. The second is that when we call `Get-Credential`, we're doing so in parentheses, which tells the shell to resolve the `Get-Credential` call before resolving the entire command. There are a few reasons to do it this way:

1. By saving a credential object as the secret instead of a password, we can pass this object into other commands when we want to run something with our -a accounts. If we just saved the password, we would have to convert it to a credential object each time we want to use it.
2. Even though we'd be saving the password as an encrypted string, we would still have to type our password into the terminal as plain text to store it.